

One-Page Workbook Analysis

Workbook: Inventory List.xlsx

Context: Public sample inventory workbook used to track stock levels, inventory value, reorder thresholds, and discontinued items.

What the Workbook Does

The workbook tracks inventory items and helps the user monitor when stock may need to be reordered. Each item includes an inventory ID, name, description, unit price, quantity in stock, reorder level, reorder time, reorder quantity, and discontinued status. The workbook also calculates the total inventory value for each item by multiplying the unit price by the quantity currently in stock.

The workbook includes additional logic that highlights items when the quantity in stock reaches or falls below the reorder level, as long as the item has not been discontinued.

Who Depends on It

A store manager, inventory manager, or purchasing employee could use this workbook to monitor available stock and determine which products may need to be reordered. The information could also support purchasing decisions and inventory planning.

If the calculations or reorder indicators are incorrect, the user could order inventory too late, purchase unnecessary stock, or overlook products that are running low.

What I Suspect Is Wrong or Fragile

I identified several areas that deserve further investigation. First, the reorder decision depends on manually entered reorder levels, so incorrect values could cause misleading reorder recommendations. Second, the workbook uses a named value and formula-based highlighting logic that may be difficult for a new user to understand or maintain. Third, the workbook does not clearly explain how reorder levels, reorder quantities, or reorder times should be determined.

These are suspected risks rather than confirmed defects and would need to be tested further.

Why I Want to Fix It

This workbook supports a real and common inventory-management task, but its decision logic could be made clearer and easier to test. I would like to improve the workbook by documenting the assumptions behind the reorder rules, validating user inputs, making the reorder decision more transparent, and eventually rebuilding important calculations in a more testable format.

The workbook is a good capstone candidate because it contains real formulas and decision logic, has a clear operational purpose, and provides several opportunities for improvement without being too large or complicated to understand.